THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 08

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

In many schools the period for games is the first to be cancelled when the syllabus runs behind. Teachers exchange a worried look, a notice is read out, and the playground is left to the dust. The assumption is that sport is a luxury and mathematics is a necessity. It is worth asking whether this is really true.

Consider what happens on a hockey field. A player must watch the ball, the opponents and her own teammates at the same time. She must decide in a second whether to pass or to run. If her team loses she must, within minutes, shake hands and go back to the game. A hundred such small decisions teach patience, judgement and good temper in a way no lecture can.

The playground teaches other lessons that a classroom finds hard to match. A team that loses learns to accept defeat without bitterness, while a team that wins learns to shake hands with humility. A child who is not selected for the first eleven discovers that effort, not wishes, decides places. Players learn to take instructions from a captain whom they may not like and to correct their mistakes in front of others. These are the very habits that the workplace demands in later life.

Doctors add a warning. Children who sit for nine or ten hours a day, in school and at home, are developing back pain and weight problems at an age when their grandparents were climbing trees. A single period of games a day, they say, is less a luxury than a medicine. A wise school will therefore guard its games period as carefully as it guards its mathematics.

Sport also teaches a kind of honesty. On the field, a player's skill cannot be hidden behind a long answer. Either the ball goes in or it does not. Players learn to accept the result, to find out why they lost and to practise until they improve. This habit of honest practice is exactly what a student needs for studies.

The body, too, has its claim. Children who play for an hour a day sleep better, concentrate longer and fall ill less often. Several studies have found that students who exercise regularly perform as well as their classmates in examinations, though they spend fewer hours at their desks. A cancelled games period saves time on paper but takes it back in tiredness. The sensible school keeps the playground open, for it is also a classroom with a larger roof.

(i) The writer begins by pointing out that in many schools: 1

(a) games periods are cancelled first **(b)** teachers play with students

(c) the playground is crowded **(d)** games are compulsory

(ii) The hockey example shows that sport teaches: 1

(a) only discipline **(b)** how to defeat others

(c) quick judgement and good temper **(d)** only physical strength

(iii) 'Sport teaches a kind of honesty' because: 1

(a) on the field skill cannot be hidden **(b)** players never lie
(c) umpires are strict **(d)** rules are strict

(iv) Children who play for an hour daily: 1

(a) sleep better and fall ill less often **(b)** become lazy
(c) score less **(d)** forget lessons

(v) 'A classroom with a larger roof' means: 1

(a) a hall **(b)** the playground
(c) a library **(d)** the sky

(vi) Why is sport treated as a luxury in some schools? 1

(vii) What must a hockey player do at the same time? 1

(viii) What habit learned from sport is useful for studies? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'something not necessary but pleasant'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'the ability to decide wisely'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

After the inter-school sports meet, the Sports Committee wished to find out which games were bringing the school success and which needed more attention. The Physical Education teacher gave the Committee the list of students who had taken part in the trials and had represented the school, along with the number of medals brought home. The information was arranged in the table below for presentation in the staff meeting.

The Sports Committee of a school recorded the number of students participating in four games and the number of medals won by the school in the last inter-school meet.

Game	Students participating	Medals won
Kabaddi	24	5
Athletics	30	8
Volleyball	18	2
Badminton	12	4

The PE teacher explained that the data should be read with care. A game with few participants may have a good ratio of medals simply because the best players were chosen with great care. She also said that facilities matter: the school has only one volleyball court, which is shared by three classes. The Principal assured the Committee that a better court would be built before the next session. She also proposed that the school hire a part-time volleyball coach and organise a practice match every Friday after school.

(i) Which game had the most participants? 1

(a) Volleyball **(b)** Athletics **(c)** Badminton **(d)** Kabaddi

(ii) In which game were the fewest medals won? 1

(a) Athletics **(b)** Kabaddi **(c)** Volleyball **(d)** Badminton

(iii) How many medals did the school win in all? 1

(a) 21 **(b)** 17 **(c)** 19 **(d)** 15

(iv) How many students took part in all the games? 1

(v) Which game gave the highest number of medals? 1

(vi) Which game had the best ratio of medals to participants? 1

(vii) How many more students took part in Athletics than in Badminton? 1

(viii) Suggest one way to improve results in volleyball. 1

(ix) What does the data suggest about the school's performance? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'a gathering for competitions'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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